

FOR CREATIVE STRATEGISTS

Why cold outreach still works in 2026.

And what has to change about yours for it to work for you.



@csos

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COLD OUTREACH IS A VOLUME GAME

If you cannot play volume, do not attempt it.

If you can, it is the fastest way to prove, to yourself and the market, that you can hold a conversation with a stranger.

01

"WON'T IT HURT MY BRAND?"

If you are relying on cold outreach as a creative strategist, your brand is not yet the thing bringing in the work.

A brand that does not exist cannot be hurt.

02

IT TEACHES YOU TO TALK TO STRANGERS

**Hundreds of first messages. Hundreds of replies.
Hundreds of opening lines tested.**

**This skill does not leave you. It shows up on every
sales call for the rest of your career.**

WHAT TO SEND

NOT THIS

A pitch. A services page. A rate. A calendar link. "Are you open to a call."

THIS

A screenshot of one of their ads. Three sentences on what you would test next.

THE STRUCTURE

- 1** Observation. One specific thing you saw.
- 2** Idea. One specific thing you would try.
- 3** No ask. "That is the thought. Reply if it lands."
- 4**
- 5**

WHAT KILLS THE REPLY

A compliment about their content. A vague offer.
A services page link. A rate. A calendar link.

Any of these signals the prospect has read it a thousand times.

THE NUMBERS TO EXPECT

Ten sent properly gets a handful of replies.

A handful of replies gets a paid conversation.

Most creative strategists give up before they have sent twenty.

THE ALTERNATIVE

If you can pay for Facebook ads for yourself, do that instead.

It is a cleaner version of the same thing.

If you cannot, outreach is the road back to that ability.

NEXT STEP

Want a read on where you are?

Take the 3-minute creative strategy quiz.

→ creativestrategyos.com/quiz